

Bringing vibrancy to the web

World Wide Web Consortium (W3C) is tasked with maintaining the specifications for CSS, which is designed to enable the separation of document content (written in any markup language like HTML) from document presentation.

In smart company

Used in many high-profile, large-scale World Wide Web products, including Wikipedia, Google and Facebook, MySQL is a relational database management system (RDBMS) that runs as a server providing multi-user access to myriad databases

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how the page will look finally. As long as you don't know CSS, you won't be able to design state of the art web sites and this will surely make your work unattractive to the discerning set of clients out there. JavaScript is the primary interactive element of a web site, and you have to be comfortable with it. Once you have mastered JavaScript, you will be able to create Ajax web sites. Then there comes the aspect of programming of web pages. A good web developer should also be well versed in PHP, ASP, Java, Perl, or C++. It will be easier for you to master these technologies if you have a mathematics background.

For someone who is looking for a simple web designing opportunity, it might not be necessary to learn MySQL Database, but for developers it is essential to learn how to build and maintain a database. Currently MySQL Database is most popular on the web. Flash, as we all know,

The two major career options for aspiring Web Developers are:

1. They can continue with Developmental role, in which case they would be doing hands on coding.
2. They can enter the field of Software Architecture, where there is less of Developmental tasks and more of complex, high-level design.

brings a great deal of charm to any web site. Both a web designer and a web developer needs to master Flash in order to create vibrant web sites. The knowledge of Web Server Management is also important for a developer or a designer. This is because web sites and databases run on web servers, whose functioning you must understand in order to fix any glitch that may crop up. Finally, you have to have the necessary skills for SEO/SEM related tasks. The Internet is awfully cluttered; it is home to more than 11.5 billion web pages. The task of making your website stand out in a cyberspace can be achieved with right kind of SEO/SEM inputs.

The premier IT institutes in India are not teaching SEO/SEM directly, but a web developer is still expected to be good at such tasks. The craft of

a SEO professional is mostly devoted to adding crucial keywords so that whenever search for those keywords is made on a search engine, the web site will show up at the top of the list.

Options for training

Major IT institutes like NIIT, Aptech and others serve as the most important recruiting ground for tech companies on lookout for web developers. Many aspiring web developers these days go in for the 3-year B.Sc. Degree course in Computer Applications, which is being offered by Aptech in collaboration with Manonmaniam Sundaranar University of Tamil Nadu. Students who have completed their HSC or 10+2, are eligible to join this course. The technology being taught include, Data Management, SQL, C++, XML, C#, .NET, Java, Linux, eCommerce, ASP.NET and few others. After this course is completed a student should have the technical know-how to carry out all sorts of web development related tasks, there is a creative side to web development as well and that is something that can come only through personal ingenuity and experience.

The other big brand in IT related educational services in the country, NIIT, too offers different kinds of certification courses, which can be eminently helpful for anyone who desires to pursue a web development career. The GNIIT course being offered by this institute is quite popular amongst students. Anyone who has passed XII with a minimum score of more than 60 per cent is eligible to apply. The course is divided into 6 semesters. In the third year, students are given on the job training, where they work in an NIIT recommended company and start earning a stipend, which can range from ₹8000 to ₹15000. The average stipend that a GNIIT student earns is around ₹12,000.

NIIT is offering certification level courses in Java, .NET, software testing, Database Programs, Open Source Programs, Storage Programs and Adobe Programs. Out of these the Adobe Programs might be of particular interest to students who want to focus on web designing, things like development of web sites

The programming languages web developers currently use include:

1. Java, C++, C#, VB.net are often utilised on the server side. Scripting languages like Pearl, VBScript, PHP are also popular.
2. JavaScript, DOM, HTML, CSS are the popular technologies currently being used on the client side.
3. For database related tasks, MySQL, Oracle, Microsoft SQL are mostly in use. XML is also used for document data transfer.

using Flash and Dreamweaver, and many other interesting arts are taught.

Students at Aptech can go in for the Graphics and Web Design course (GWD), a 1-year program with 2 semesters, during which a thorough grounding in Graphics design and Web design can be expected. Students who have completed their 10+2 are eligible to take the course. The GWD course covers graphics, illustrations, composition and layout for print design, web design, web graphics and animation. The software related subjects covered in this course include Adobe Photoshop, Adobe Illustrator, CorelDRAW, HTML, Dreamweaver, Flash and JavaScript.

Making a mark as a web developer

It is necessary for a student to do a comprehensive research before actually joining an institute. There is no point in spending time and money in an institute where the education, infrastructure or the post-course placement services are not be up to the mark. An efficient web developer is not only someone who is well versed in latest technology, he is also someone who is capable of executing projects, communicating with clients, and he should be capable of coming up with ingenious out of the box solutions for most intricate problems.

"Sky is the limit for developers who are capable of doing a good job," says Anju Dalal of Arena. "A good fresher can go up the employment ladder in a matter of six months. The companies are always on look out for efficient web developers." ■